WHAT IT TAKES TO WIN

What It Takes To Win (WITTW) is each national sporting organisation's own evidence based model of what an athlete or crew must be able to do to win at the pinnacle event. It belongs to the sport and is the reference point that planning, categorisation and investment are measured against.

WHAT IT IS

- Owned by the sport. Each NSO writes and holds its own WITTW. The AIS and state institutes help build and test it but do not own it.
- Performance backwards. It starts from the winning performance at the pinnacle event and works back to the physical, technical, tactical and mental capabilities that performance requires.
- Event specific. Skate street and park, surfing shortboard, sprint kayak and canoe and triathlon individual and mixed relay each need their own model.
- Living. It is refreshed after each pinnacle event and when formats or judging criteria change.

HOW IT IS BUILT

Sports build and review their WITTW in workshops organised around the AIS performance drivers.

Athletes	Capabilities needed at the pinnacle event
Coaching	Coaching and learning development that builds them
DTE	What the daily training environment must provide
Competitions	Benchmark events that test readiness
Talent ID	Where the next athletes come from
Leadership	How the program is led and its culture held
Innovation	Where research and technology close gaps faster

WHAT IT FEEDS

WITTW is the benchmark the rest of the system is measured against. It runs in a straight line from model to money.

1 GAP ANALYSIS
Each athlete is profiled against the WITTW

2 IPP
The Individual Performance Plan addresses those gaps

3 ADF
The pathway sets what each stage should look like

4 CATEGORISATION
Evidence of future podium capability

5 INVESTMENT
AIS and NIN funding and services follow

Under the National Athlete Categorisation Framework athletes are placed at one of five levels. Placement rests on evidence of future podium capability against the sport's WITTW and is reviewed every year. The old fixed two year timelines and the International category have been removed.

EMERGING | DEVELOPING | PODIUM POTENTIAL | PODIUM READY | **PODIUM**

THE LANGUAGE

WITTW	The sport's model of what winning requires at the pinnacle event
PE	Pinnacle event such as the Olympic Games or a world championship
BME	Benchmark event used to test progress towards the PE
DPE or DTE	Daily performance or daily training environment
IPP	Individual Performance Plan built from the gap analysis
ADF	Athlete Development Framework, the sport's pathway
NACF	National Athlete Categorisation Framework
NIN	National Institute Network, the AIS with the state institutes including QAS
Win Well	Results achieved with integrity and athlete wellbeing

WHERE QAS FITS

QAS does not write a sport's WITTW. It helps the sport deliver against it in the Queensland daily training environment and aligns its own investment to the gaps the model exposes. QAS staff also contribute evidence to categorisation panels as part of the NIN.

- Skate Australia states that its categorisation relies more heavily on the sport's WITTW and Athlete Development Frameworks.
- AusTriathlon lists alignment with WITTW as a guiding principle of its 2032+ strategy.
- For Surfing and Paddle, ask the PSM early whether a current version exists and when it was last refreshed.

USING IT IN THE PRESENTATION AND INTERVIEW

- Always say the sport's WITTW, never one QAS or the HPM owns.
- Listen phase: read each sport's WITTW, ADF and athlete IPPs before forming a view.
- Resourcing: QAS investment follows the gaps each WITTW shows.
- On track: progress is read against the WITTW, benchmark events and categorisation movement.
- Avoid offering to build or rebuild a WITTW in the first 90 days, since that would cut across the sport's ownership.

SOURCES

Skate Australia athlete categorisation · AusTriathlon strategy · AusTriathlon 2032+ high performance strategy launch · AusCycling pathways categorisation · AIS National Institute Network